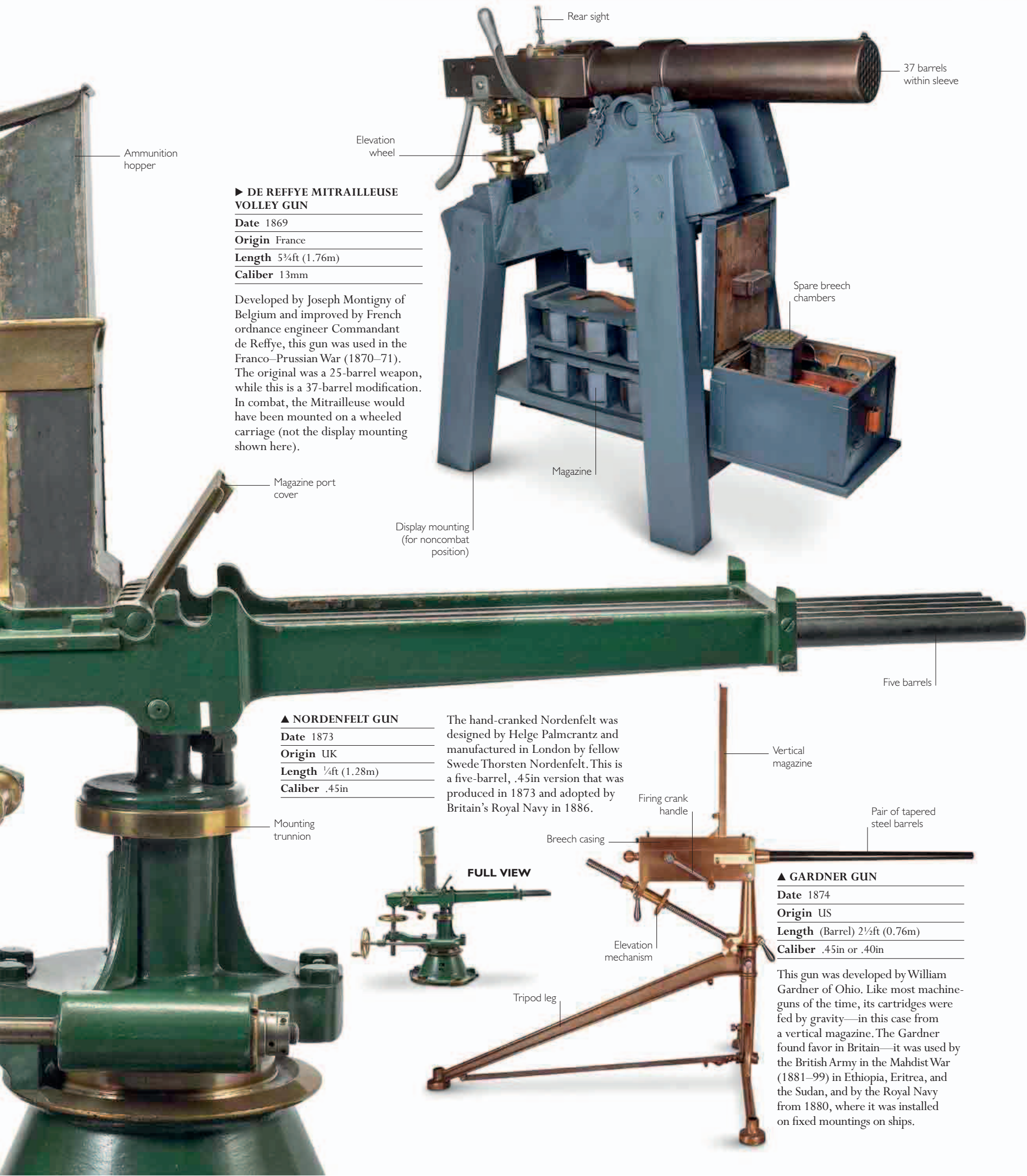




► DE REFFYE MITRAILLEUSE VOLLEY GUN

Date 1869

Origin France

Length 5¾ft (1.76m)

Caliber 13mm

Developed by Joseph Montigny of Belgium and improved by French ordnance engineer Commandant de Reffye, this gun was used in the Franco-Prussian War (1870–71). The original was a 25-barrel weapon, while this is a 37-barrel modification. In combat, the Mitrailleuse would have been mounted on a wheeled carriage (not the display mounting shown here).

Magazine port cover

Display mounting (for noncombat position)

Magazine

Rear sight

37 barrels within sleeve

Spare breech chambers

▲ NORDENFELT GUN

Date 1873

Origin UK

Length ¼ft (1.28m)

Caliber .45in

The hand-cranked Nordenfelt was designed by Helge Palmcrantz and manufactured in London by fellow Swede Thorsten Nordenfelt. This is a five-barrel, .45in version that was produced in 1873 and adopted by Britain's Royal Navy in 1886.

Mounting trunnion

FULL VIEW

Vertical magazine

Firing crank handle

Breech casing

Pair of tapered steel barrels

Elevation mechanism

Tripod leg

▲ GARDNER GUN

Date 1874

Origin US

Length (Barrel) 2½ft (0.76m)

Caliber .45in or .40in

This gun was developed by William Gardner of Ohio. Like most machine-guns of the time, its cartridges were fed by gravity—in this case from a vertical magazine. The Gardner found favor in Britain—it was used by the British Army in the Mahdist War (1881–99) in Ethiopia, Eritrea, and the Sudan, and by the Royal Navy from 1880, where it was installed on fixed mountings on ships.